

The Glorious King of Investigative Tantras of Vajrabhairava

Śrī Vajrabhairava Kalpa Tantra Rāja · Toh 470 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་རྫོང་ཐུགས་བརྟེན་གྱི་ཕལ་རྫོང་གྱི་ཕལ་

Toh 470 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Vajrabhairava Kalpa Tantra Rāja and in Tibetan as the Dpal rdo rje 'jigs byed kyi rtog pa'i rgyud, rendered in English as the Glorious King of Investigative Tantras of Vajrabhairava. It belongs to the class of Highest Yoga Tantras centered on Vajrabhairava, the wrathful deity who is a fierce manifestation of Mañjuśrī and whose practice is concerned with the subjugation of Yama, the lord of death, and the liberation of beings from suffering through secret mantra accomplishment. The text is structured as a series of investigations, or kalpa sections, and the portion preserved here constitutes what is labeled the third such investigation, suggesting it forms part of a larger tantric cycle related to the Black Yamāntaka tradition. As a canonical tantra of the Vajrayāna, it sits within the Kangyur alongside other Vajrabhairava and Yamāntaka scriptures, presenting ritual and meditational instructions involving wrathful deity yoga, mantra, and the esoteric deployment of protective and liberating forces.

This concludes the third investigation, concerning the tantra of the tantra and the reliance upon companions.

The glorious Black Yamāntaka Tantra, third investigation, is complete.

In the language of India: Śrī Vairabhairava Kalpa Tantra Rāja.

In the language of Tibet: The Glorious King of Investigative Tantras of Vajrabhairava.

Homage to the Lord of Speech.

Now here shall be taught
the supreme great method of accomplishment
that exhausts beings and liberates them from suffering,
from which the secret mantra arises.

First is Vairocana,
and close to him, the Lord of Speech,
who turns the *vaira* wheel.

The lord of spirits and the master of elemental beings shall be made to possess the two seeds of humanity.

Together with the extremities, they burn the stūpa.
By others this will not be understood,
for it abides in the sky of the vajra holder.

If one recites a thousand hundred thousand syllables,
all downfalls are cleared away,
and the pacifying, enriching, magnetizing, and wrathful rites,
killing, expelling, summoning, separating,
subjugating, and sovereignty and so forth —
their attainment is without doubt.

In a charnel ground, among thorns, at the rough bank of a pit,
in a solitary forest, an empty house, or secluded at midnight,
begin the meditation at whatever place one desires.

Then the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called
"Mirror-Like, Pervading All Manifestations," and in order to pervade all bodies
and all primordial wisdom, he manifested with a white form possessing five
faces. Having beheld all worldly beings and having recited the syllable of his
own family, his body, speech, mind, qualities, and activities, as well as
primordial wisdom, arose as an emanation body of a single essential nature.

How wondrous, Blessed Vajra Great One,
the very same who generates all meanings!
He who fills the middle of space with light,
radiant again with five colors,
the body of the Sage at the crest of light's rays,
stirred by the seed syllable mantra —
all arise from the abode of the buddhas,
and by entering into oneself the body becomes complete.

Six-faced, with knitted brows and supreme ferocity,
with the face of a buffalo, abiding above,
the face of Mañjuśrī remaining with a smile,
the remaining faces red, yellow, and blue,
with hair blazing upward like the color of smoke,
adorned with dry and fresh skulls, intestines, and serpents,
ornamented with a garland of vajra bones,
wearing the skin of a great elephant and a tiger,
and whose song is the Hūṃ and Phaṭ,

a wrathful cloud with a sky-like body,
that emanates again and again —
with six arms of supreme brilliance:
the staff, the hammer, and the pestle
he holds in succession with the right hands;
the adversary's stake, the iron hook,
and the lasso he holds with the left hands.
With a lotus, sun, and buffalo,
he stands prancing upon Yama,
with six feet, the left extended, in a dancing posture,
the master of the world who reduces all to the extreme.

Thus one who has faith
and intelligence, having thoroughly abandoned duplicity and deceit,
having properly obtained the empowerments
and having pleased the vajra master,
if one recalls again and again,
one will attain great stability.

O divine Saṅgha, hear me:
delight greatly in the hero who bears the skull-cup;
if one continually drinks the great flesh in one's mouth,
all activities will swiftly be accomplished.

The body emits many bodies,
and bodies are certainly dissolved back into the body.
Knowing that all is illusion,
one awakens minds throughout the worlds.

The inner hollow channel is the pillar,
from which bodhicitta continuously drips.
The two red lotuses joined mouth to mouth,
well pressed together by the two limbs —
the fire and wind that increase awareness,
the sun and moon, method and wisdom —
know these to be endowed with skillful means and wisdom.
If those two are abandoned,
penetration will not occur.

Relying upon the joining of the two lotuses
and the meditative absorption abiding in the three places,
sealed by the vajra Dharma —
the intelligent one who strives will understand
this cause of liberation through method and wisdom.
Therefore one should apply oneself to it.

Since phenomena and the nature of reality are inseparable,
the great primordial wisdom of emptiness
is indestructible, free from conceptuality, without characteristics.

In the body of the vajra of great-bliss wisdom,
wisdom is non-conceptual, free from conceptuality.
It burns away all the characteristics of conceptuality;
all the characteristics of conceptual elaboration,
however many illusory forms there are — know them as such.
Having known suchness, one is liberated.
Through not knowing it, one revolves again in cyclic existence.

For the few intelligent persons of the world
who have determined the supreme of methods through reflection,
frightened greatly by great suffering,
and desiring happiness — let them apply themselves with diligence.

This concludes the first chapter — the chapter teaching the meditative
concentration of method and wisdom — from the King of Tantras of
Conceptual Categories of Glorious Vajrabhairava.

Now, what is to be rightly explained:
the ritual actions arising from accomplished mantra
are to be known here.
The deity's body too is to be applied there.

In the sequence of recitation for the pacifying rites and so forth:
at the center of the vajra, the vajra —
resting upon sun and moon, the rosary of syllables
is to be known as having five colors.
Having abandoned rough recitation, the reading
is the sequence of recitation of the wise.

For the accomplishment of fierce rites:
the wheel that cuts through afflictions —

yellow, with ten spokes and ten points —
visualize it radiating rays of variegated light.

The person who desires pacification,
having properly placed the mind in equanimity,
should also direct the light of the mantra toward other beings,
accompanied by the intention to benefit them.

On linen cloth and on tree bark,
with saffron, musk, and perfumes,
make a stupa with five tiers,
furnished with a canopy and a wheel.
Write the name and clan of the practitioner
inside that vessel.

Write the mantra beginning with Ye Dharmā
going around from the left;
write the other version from right to left.

Place there many empowering words,
or else set it within the wheel.

Having properly affixed the joining-point of all the wheel's parts,
and firmly established it,
place it on the body, at the throat, or wherever is comfortable.

By this, spirits, sorcery,
epidemics, and contagious diseases are dispelled.

For one who desires to subjugate territories:

write the mere name-letters together with the HŪṂ seed-syllable.

Sprinkle them with the powdered grain of a flat wheat cake, the blood of a
boar,

and the blood of a camel and a buffalo.

Make the form of a crescent moon
and within it accomplish whatever is desired.

Making an image eight finger-widths in measure,
lay it face up.

Having recited the mantra one hundred thousand times
with the conjunction of the buffalo-face method,
cut it into pieces,

and throw it into the current of a river —
in that very instant, that one comes under the power.

Make figures of a raven and an owl.
From the manumālī and rocana,
write the name of the husband one wishes to subjugate.
Facing the direction of the Lord of Death (Yama), utter the secret mantra.
Having pressed it down with the left foot,
strike it with a phurpa at a man's frenulum.
In a mere instant those two are separated.

Then here the sequence of the rite for killing is to be explained.
With six faces, six arms, and six feet,
or alternatively with one face and four arms,
or also with one face and two arms — either is suitable.
With the conjunction of the buffalo-face method,
using various different bloods,
the victim's tracks and types of poison,
and the water of a horse, a buffalo, a donkey,
make a liṅga of the one to be subjugated.
Make a form on the body with thorns
and also anoint it with sesame oil.
Alternatively, on a leaf, a wheat stalk,
a charnel-ground cloth, or bark,
oneself naked, hair disheveled,
the body smeared with ash —
with open anger, eat great flesh,
and drink deeply satisfying liquor.
At the midnight hour of the dark lunar fortnight,
begin writing the wheel.

The wheel has twelve edges.
Place HŪṂ and HRĪḤ ṢṬRĪḤ at the center.
On the ṇa, yo, ni, ra spokes and in the armpit positions,
write with white mustard, sesame, musk-oil,
the blood of a horse, a buffalo, a goat, a dog,
and the feathers of a raven and an owl.
In the belly of the syllable YA as well,
write it together with name and clan.
In the four directions, write the syllable groups of ten
together with the name.

Write these syllables in order upon all eight of them:

OM MUSALE CURṆA RĀGA CARAṆA CU ŚĀNA HŪṀ HŪṀ HŪṀ PHAṬ PHAṬ PHAṬ

Encircling the syllable YA,
write it together with the form of the one to be accomplished.

Around its border,
write the ten syllables together with the name.

In the four directions, mark with the three-pointed vajra.

Likewise, using all the substances without remainder,
write the wheel furnished with a belly.

Draw the form of Yama (the Lord of Death), holding a sword
and a club.

Then place the two — both of them — belly to belly,
and insert them inside a malefic-sign skull.

Fill it with the three hot things, the long-pepper, poison, and musk,
along with the impurity of a corpse,
and set the maṇḍala in the center of a triangular hearth.

Recite the sovereign mantra over mustard, grain, black rice,
jābhi grain, and the rest,
until they are warm or until smoke rises.

By consuming without remainder all epidemic disease
and the blood of those with epidemic disease,
practice meditative concentration without distraction.
Or else one may perceive the one to be accomplished eating.

At the base of a single tree — wild and disheveled;
beneath a bed — mute and dumb;
at a river confluence — cast out;
at a slaughter site — concealed beneath a hearth;
for drawing toward — beneath a threshold;
for turning — a deity or a wheel.

By these means, those in comfortable stations will be brought under control.

Melting great quantities of butter inside a skull,
if one strains it and anoints the eyes with it,
one will swiftly attain clairvoyance.

Obtained from a noble king,
bringing in a fresh, radiant, youthful woman,
one makes many sandalwood keys,
and binds her by means of the karma-rite.

Or the accomplishment comes by tormenting with fire.

Reciting the mantra thus:

OM VAJRA KRODHĀYA MARĀJA VAJRA KĪLI KĪLA HĀNA HANA MĀRAYA PHAṬ
one drives in a bone peg.

Inserted into a piece of wood, the rite is accomplished
by relying on substances connected to the person.

Anointed with sesame oil and pressed with a skull,
by the smoke of a butter lamp made from it,
sharp eyesight will be accomplished.

Although there are many attainments to be gained
through relying upon the unobstructed sovereign mantra,
what need is there to enumerate them all here?

Or else this should be understood as follows:

if one possesses the mantra and meditative absorption oneself,
and with great diligence does not allow the mind to wander,
whatever one undertakes will be accomplished.

A self-arisen prostitute —

having first shown her the wheel as described above and written it well —
inserts it into the center of her liṅga.

In front of oneself, upon a blood crescent,
place it upon a surface smeared with blood.

Human daughters or daughters of kings —
by means of the letters of invocation and domination,
they will assuredly come to that very spot.

It should be pressed beneath the sleeping place.

Write the wheel using the blood of a human, an ox, a goat, a dog, a rhinoceros,
and a pig,

and insert it into the neck of the liṅga.

Then write the blood-vomiting spell with raven blood,
insert the syllables of that kind into a skull,
recite the mantra many times,

and place it beneath the charnel-ground hearth:
there is no doubt it will cause vomiting of blood.

If it is heated, death by a fever disease results.

Write that very wheel well, using the blood of a frog, a fox-brain,
insert it into the left armpit of the liṅga,
and smear the right and left with ox blood and frog blood.
Press it in the direction of the liṅga
with the big toe of one's own left foot.
At that time, recite the mantra many times,
then press it down and leave it on a crossroads path.
Write the reversal of that,
and if concealed in the hollow of a single tree, it causes paralysis.

Using the blood of a female fox and an old raven,
write the wheel, insert it between the two legs of the liṅga,
in front of oneself.

Draw the form of a female fox in blood,
and place it upon that.
If one possesses certainty in wind meditation,
there is no doubt it will drive away.
Climb to a mountain peak and conceal it there.

Using the blood of a mongoose, a snake, a horse, a buffalo,
a raven, and an owl,
smearing it on the footprint-tracked soles of a leather shoe,
one makes the liṅga eight finger-breadths long.
Made into two, the wheels written with that blood
are inserted into the chest area.
Make the form of a mongoose and place it on top.
Strike with the bones of a horse and a buffalo on both sides,
reciting the mantra.
Dragged by the tip and concealed at the root of a tree — it scatters.

Carefully written with white sandalwood
and rolled up with gold and other precious substances,
placed in front upon a moon-disc,
circumambulated each day —
for as long as this is done, protection is assured.
Tied to the crown of the head, one conquers in battle.
Tied to the feet, one walks upon water.

Bathed with cow's milk,
with kuśa grass, butter, and so forth as offerings,

and with prayers made, it protects against all diseases.

Then the Blessed One entered the meditative absorption called "Victorious over All Subtle Actions," and from the vajra of his body, speech, and mind he brought forth this mantra that follows all actions:

māra ya phaṭ — the seed-syllable of slaying.

bidveṣa ya — the seed-syllable of separating.

ucchāṭa ya — the seed-syllable of expelling.

moha ya — the seed-syllable of bewildering.

vaśaṃ kuru — the seed-syllable of bringing under power.

stambha ya — the seed-syllable of suppressing.

ākaraṣa ya jaḥ — the seed-syllable of hooking and drawing in.

oṃ hrīḥ svāhā — the seed-syllable of offering.

oṃ idaṃ gha svāhā — the seed-syllable of refreshing the mouth.

oṃ duṣṭa svāhā — the seed-syllable of incense.

oṃ bho yaṃ jaḥ ja — the seed-syllable of flowers.

oṃ ṣṭi ha he phaṭ phaṭ — the seed-syllable of fumigation.

oṃ dīpo dhana maya svāhā — the seed-syllable of lamps.

oṃ vajra naivedya āḥ hūṃ svāhā — the seed-syllable of food offerings.

oṃ kāla rūpa sattva damaka mahābhūtapati idaṃ bali gṛhṇāpaya svāhā — the seed-syllable of the torma.

oṃ hrīḥ yama rāja ehy ehi āgaccha bhagavān sarvaṃ māṃsa me damadza rudhira priye bhakṣa bhakṣa mama sarva sattva damaka karma kuru siddhi sme svāhā — the seed-syllable for invoking the deity.

oṃ hrīḥ vajra jaye su jaye mahā vajra jaye muni vajra muḥ — the seed-syllable for requesting the deity and the others to depart.

Then the Vajra-Holder himself entered the meditative absorption called "Following and Reversing All Phenomena," and declared this very activity of fully complete secret mantra:

Visualize, abiding in the center of the expanse of space,

born fully complete from the syllable hūṃ,

Vajrabhairava — the vajra terrifier.

Red, with one face and two arms,

united in union with the wisdom consort,

holding a club and a skull-cup of blood in his hands.

Meditate upon him in this manner:

his left leg extended,
standing upon a water buffalo, a lotus, and the sun.

oṃ yamāntakṛt hūṃ phaṭ.

Recite this, the king of secret mantras,
and all desired siddhis will arise.

Abiding in the center of the expanse of space,
born from the blue syllable ya,
the wrathful one, Vajrabhairava,
rests upon a seat of lotus and sun,
seated in the heroic posture.

In his four hands he holds in succession:
a curved knife, a vidyā-pā-la,
an enemy-stake, and a skull-cup of blood.

Above the black buffalo face
is the yellow smiling face of Mañjuśrī.

Meditate on yourself as this great hero.

Drinking deeply of excellent wine,
eating great amounts of meat,
wandering through charnel grounds at night,
always reciting the secret mantra.

Direct your meditation toward the object of your practice
in the yoga of drawing the bindu.

All actions will be swiftly accomplished by this.

Alternatively, know it in this way:

Through the combination with the buffalo face,
the distinct colors of the body are each discerned.

Especially for slaying:

the one with the black buffalo face
holds a three-pointed iron hook.

If one meditates imagining him upon the buffalo's flesh,
it is declared supreme for drawing blood.

At times, on his body, the wrathful one
proliferates iron hooks without number.

At the time when the moon is seized by the fox —
mixing cat claws, rabbit heart,

bird blood, and human bones,
whoever is struck by this will go mad.

This is the second chapter, on the applications, from the King of Tantras of the
Compendium of Glorious Vajrabhairava.

Then, once more, what is to be properly explained.

The yogin who carries out the practice
should dye cloth with charnel-ground linen, hero's cloth,
or a night-shroud covering,
using Vairocana water, vajra water,
hero's blood, wine, poison,
and gorochana,
drawing it tightly and well.

In the places of body, speech, and mind,
with water endowed with the five nectars,
write the syllables om̐, āḥ, hūṃ.

With half-shaved head, with charnel-ground ash,
smearing with great blood and buffalo marrow,
one who has received empowerment guards the samaya,
and the artist who is utterly secret and supreme,
endowed with diligence,
having made himself learned in the meaning of the tantra,
at midnight on the dark-moon day,
having fully entered the secret place,
draws the Blessed One Vajrabhairava.

The root face is that of the wrathful buffalo.

Above it is the smiling face of Mañjuśrī.

The remaining faces are red, yellow, and blue,
with upswept hair the color of smoke,
blazing with fierce magnificence, wrathful of countenance.

The body is great, endowed with six faces.

Adorned with dry and moist skulls, intestines, and serpents,
and with a garland of bones and vajras,
wearing the hide of elephant and tiger,
upon a lotus and sun, pressing down upon the buffalo,
with six feet he stands in the dance pose, left extended, right bent.

The first of the six right hands holds a single-pointed implement,
the second a hammer,
the third a pestle raised aloft to the sky.
A foe-axe, an iron hook, and a lasso —
draw the left hands holding these.
Smeared with ash, the color of the sky,
many wrathful emanations stream from the body.
He is surrounded by goddesses offering various offerings.

Thus, when it has been drawn precisely in this way,
draw great charnel grounds surrounding it on the back and in all directions:
severed heads, intestines carried through the sky,
stumps of legs and stumps of arms, and risen corpses,
fierce foxes and wolves,
assemblies of male and female *ḍākinīs* who eat flesh,
birds and various wild beasts — draw all of these.
Draw a skull-drum that is most terrifying.
Then draw the practitioner himself as well,
holding a skull-cup and knife, sitting amidst great flesh,
wearing black robes and drinking great blood,
holding a rosary of horse and buffalo bones, and reciting secret mantras.
Draw him gazing up toward the Blessed One.

Having drawn it thus, make offerings with wine, blood,
great flesh, and *gorocheda*.
If the Saṅgha of the gods in meditative equipoise
makes offerings continuously throughout the three times,
one swiftly attains the state of Vajradhara.
The body is supremely concealed and secret.
These supreme benefits arise from this.

This is the third chapter, on the painted image, from the King of Tantras of the
Compendium of Glorious Vajrabhairava.

Then, what is to be properly explained once more.
Desiring to accomplish all activities, exhausting every conceptual elaboration,
the wise one, having fully abandoned miserliness,
having abandoned carelessness and distraction,
should apply himself diligently to the work of fire oblation.

With vermillion, buffalo marrow,
the ash-dust of a butcher's charnel-ground site,
sprinkle with human and buffalo blood.
Build up a cubit and a half in depth, half a cubit in width.
Above its four sides make a round form
with a vajra-cross design.
On top of that, on a wheel with six spokes,
place six symbolic marks.
At the center, make the fire maṇḍala,
raised to the height of one span,
and coat it well with buffalo blood.
Oneself, facing toward the south,
with the approach of the buffalo-faced one,
gazing directly at the seed of fire
in the inner quarters of the fire pit,
meditate as though on the great fire at the end of an eon.
There, meditate also on the fire deity:
three faces, four arms, dark and rough.
Two arms embrace a consort similar to himself.
The right arms grant refuge to beings and hold a counting rosary.
The left strives to offer the supreme pill.
Six feet are marked with the signs of the six classes of beings.
From the mouth, fires blaze forth brilliantly,
adorned with lights of various kinds.
Knowing it thus, when one burns the oblation,
all desired aims arise abundantly.

If one burns the form of an enemy together with great flesh,
wine, and buffalo blood,
three thousand times,
the target vomits blood and dies.

With elephant, horse, donkey, and dog flesh,
three thousand oblations bring it under one's power.

If one burns crow, owl, dog flesh, and water,
humans and horses will certainly scatter and flee.

Sesame, barley, wheat, sālu rice,
myrobalan, asafoetida, and boar tusks —

if six thousand of these are burned in offering,
all wealth and prosperity will be found.

With horse, female mule, and crow flesh,
human flesh, and vajra water,
endowed with the yoga of secret mantra,
one hundred and eight oblations will certainly drive away.

Goat flesh, blue lotus,
wine, and buffalo water —

one hundred and eight oblations with whatever one desires will silence.

Poison, blood, garlic,
and boar flesh, rendered with sesame oil —
if one hundred and eight oblations of these are burned,
the mantras and spells of others on the opposing side will be cut.

White sandalwood, white rice,
white sesame, hulled rice, white mustard,
white and red lotus, and camphor —
facing east, one hundred and eight
oblations burned will protect throughout all times.

Whoever performs the rites of averting pestilence and the like
with mantras and with assured meditative concentration,
not parting from a mind of compassion —
all desires shall be accomplished right here.

Otherwise, certain childish fools benighted in delusion,
devoid of intelligence, with wisdom gone awry,
whose mantra and sacred commitment have grown weak,
who are negligent and openly slack in meditative absorption,
who are of little diligence and lax —
even if they were to practice for a thousand aeons,
there would be no fruit whatsoever;
they will end up utterly exhausted.

For example, just as the dull-witted and childish,
misguided in their wish for fruit,
beat threshing chaff into the wind
and never obtain any grain —

Just as clouds, a moon reflected in water,
and the rainbow of Indra's bow are not permanent —
so too the activity aimed at liberation
is illusion playing within illusion.

Wisdom alone is the cause of complete freedom.
What can the mind gauge when measuring emptiness?
If one investigates and attempts to fathom it,
there is no essential core to be found therein through analysis.
If things are not established therein,
what need is there to speak of other levels of practice?
Action and agent —
surely these cannot withstand examination there.

It is better to fall into a ravine or a chasm
than to bear this thought of annihilation.
But eternalism also is not right understanding —
how could there be any existent thing?

For example, just as a mother to her children,
saying "Stay here on this earth, dear" —
taking much fruit and produce from the trees,
says "I give you this with love" —

just so, in many ways,
because the conceptual frameworks of worldly beings differ,
those teachings were given in order to guide them.

Before the Blessed One, the God of Gods,
the food portions of boar flesh
and also wine, sesame oil, buffalo blood,
and the finest, most delightful foods —
these shall always be offered at all times.

The secret mantra king of ten syllables —
I shall recite it continuously,
and always strive in meditative concentration.

Thus, the intelligent person who knows this and practices accordingly
will swiftly accomplish even buddhahood itself —
what need is there to speak of the activities of pacification and the rest?

When the mantra-holder wishes to throw a city into turmoil,
he should burn dog flesh, frog flesh, turtle flesh,
and the flesh of the female cat —
one thousand one hundred and eight oblations.

Horse flesh mixed with great musk,
made into pills and placed before oneself —
reciting the secret mantra king,
one hundred and eight oblations burned
will bring a king under one's power.

If one wishes to bring a woman under one's power,
fish flesh, wine, and boar flesh
mixed with vajra water —
one hundred and eight oblations shall be burned.

If one wishes to bring an ordinary person under one's power,
boar flesh together with elephant flesh,
mixed with bodhicitta —
eight thousand oblations shall be burned.

For summoning at all times:
dog flesh, fish flesh, and the five nectars,
made into equal portions as pills —
if one hundred and eight oblations are burned, it summons.

All fire-offering rites whatsoever —
combined with buffalo-faced preparation,
joined with the secret mantra king, apply one's wishes —
do this with an undistracted, one-pointed mind.

All that has been taught and not yet taught,
in accordance with the proper sequence,
dwelling close to the tantra king itself,
the fruit of buddhahood will be swiftly attained.

For pacification, with a pacified and peaceful mind;
for expansion, as a king would, with attachment free of aversion;
for wrathful activities, with a fierce and rough
and utterly ferocious mind,
one should be endowed with the intent to slay.

As for the person who is independent of all reliance
and seeks swift accomplishment —
through the naturally pure nature of mind,
the vajra-holder will be accomplished.

Whatever things and whatever sphere of activity —
one moves through the intrinsic nature of each and every thing.
Meditative equipoise must not be allowed to degrade;
at all times the yogin
should rest in perfect equipoise.

This is the very cause of liberation.
From this, the king of tantras,
the accomplishments one desires are swiftly achieved.
This method, free of hardship,
abandoning the austerities and ascetic observances,
is the method for achieving with supreme ease —
the taste of ambrosia, fearless of suffering.
The intelligent should take it up with care
and accomplish it with utmost effort.

When some foolish and confused mind of little understanding
is obscured by the net of conceptual thought,
it examines things under two categories:
the aggregate of merit and the aggregate of misdeeds.
And yet, since every desire without exception
arises from this supreme tantra,
even one who is of modest capacity and little diligence,
upon entering this, swiftly accomplishes.

Therefore this tantra, so wondrous,
rare and supremely excellent —
if even its written characters are not to be shown to others,
what need is there to speak of explaining and expounding it?
If the empowerments have not duly been received
and the guru has not been satisfied,
then even if it is taught, it will not be obtained;
instead one will cycle through the realms of sorrow,
such as the hells, and the rest.

When the Teacher spoke these words,
the assembled host was intoxicated and overwhelmed a hundredfold;
all bowed down with heads inclined,
and this world shook with great trembling.

Whoever hears this tantra,
and knowing it, holds it,
and at all times recites it —
in this very life all fears are dispelled,
and upon death one swiftly attains the higher realms.

If, however, one were to teach, explain, or openly reveal
this supreme tantra to others who are inappropriate,
that person, having experienced manifold suffering,
will upon death swiftly go to hell.

But if one guards it with utmost care
and actually manifests the accomplishments as they truly are,
then, all suffering being definitively exhausted,
one will swiftly attain the unsurpassed.

This is the fourth chapter, opening the section on the fire-offering ritual, from
the Tantra King of Conceptual Elaborations of Glorious Vajrabhairava.

The work entitled Examination of the Accomplishments of Action from the King
of Conceptual Elaborations of Glorious Vajrabhairava is complete.

Translated and revised by the great paṇḍita Amogha, who is known as
Capable-of-Power, together with the Tibetan translator Marpa Bandé Chökyi
Wangchuk Drakpa.

Subsequently, it was heard directly from the presence of the great
accomplished master Karṇaśrī by the translator Tarpa Lotsāwa.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "the two red lotuses joined mouth to mouth" and the surrounding passage concerns the sexual yoga of union practice (karmamudra or jñānamudra) within the Vajrabhairava tantric context. The "inner hollow channel," "bodhicitta continuously dripping," "fire and wind," "sun and moon," and "the two limbs" are standard tantric anatomical-energetic metaphors (nāḍī, bindu, candālī, prāṇa). These are not metaphors for conventional meditation but refer to the completion-stage yogas. The translation renders them literally in accordance with the text's own register.

The phrase "the two seeds of humanity" is an unusual expression; it likely refers to two specific seed syllables associated with human beings or to male and female principles. Some uncertainty remains as to the precise ritual referent.

The line "if one continually drinks the great flesh in one's mouth" likely refers to the tantric feast substance (mahāmāṃsa), one of the sacred substances of the gaṇacakra feast ritual, rather than literal consumption.

- The phrase rendered "rough recitation" (ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་) refers to recitation that is hasty, careless, or done while distracted — the contrast being with the deliberate, meditatively precise recitation described as the proper "sequence of recitation of the wise." This is a technical distinction in tantric recitation manuals.

The term "manumālī" (མཎུ་མཎུ་) is a transliteration of a Sanskrit term for a specific ritual substance (likely a plant or mineral compound); its exact identification is uncertain.

The phrase "frenulum" (མཎུ་མཎུ་) is literally "the frenulum area of a man" — a precise anatomical location used in this fierce rite. The reading is certain; the doctrinal context is a fierce subjugation and separation ritual.

The syllables ṇa, yo, ni, ra in the wheel-description are transliterations of Tibetan phonetic renderings of a Sanskrit-derived mantra formula assigned to specific spoke positions; no further gloss is possible from context alone.

- The passage is a ritual manual (sādhana or prayoga) describing wrathful rite procedures including subjugation, invocation, blood-vomiting curses, expulsion, and paralysis rites. The mantra strings are rendered phonetically as they appear in Tibetan transliteration without normalization, since these are quasi-Sanskrit or hybrid mantra syllables whose "correct" Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain. The term "liṅga" throughout refers to an effigy figure used in ritual operations, not the anatomical or Śaiva sense, though the text plays on the ambiguity in the context of sexual subjugation rites. The phrase translated "self-arisen prostitute" renders a technical ritual category of woman considered to possess innate power; the precise technical meaning within this tradition is not fully recoverable from context alone.

- The mantra syllables and seed-syllable explanations are preserved as they appear in the Tibetan, with transliterated Sanskrit. Several of the mantric sequences contain corrupt or abbreviated forms typical of ritual tantric texts; they are rendered faithfully without normalization.

The term "vidyā-pā-la" in the list of implements held in the four hands renders a transliterated Tibetan term that likely represents a Sanskrit original meaning "protector of the vidyā-mantra" or possibly a skull-staff; the exact form is uncertain and may be a scribal variant.

"The moon seized by the fox" refers to a lunar eclipse as understood in traditional Indian astronomy, where the eclipse-causing entity is sometimes figured as a fox or similar creature in Tibetan adaptations; this is a ritual timing instruction.

- The phrase rendered "sitting amidst great flesh" for ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ is slightly uncertain: ལྷོ་ may indicate the practitioner is sitting immersed in or surrounded by great flesh, which is the standard iconographic context; this reading is adopted.

The term ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ is rendered "vajra-cross design," referring to the crossed-vajra or viśvavajra symbol used in ritual hearth construction.

The text ends mid-sentence, breaking off at the description of a new oblation formula; no translation beyond the extant Tibetan has been supplied.

- The phrase rendered "silence" at the opening continues directly from the preceding passage's verse pattern about making persons mute; the Tibetan ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ means "mute, dumb,

silenced."

The term "bodhicitta" in the fire-offering context for subjugation refers to a tantric ritual substance of that name, not the awakening mind in the doctrinal sense; this dual usage is standard in tantric ritual literature.

The closing line is incomplete in the source, breaking off mid-verse, consistent with a passage boundary.

- The colophon names two translators in sequence. The first translation session is attributed to the great paṇḍita Amogha (likely Amoghavajra or a figure with a similar epithet) and the Tibetan lotsāwa Marpa Bandé Chökyi Wangchuk Drakpa. A subsequent revision or transmission is attributed to Tarpa Lotsāwa, who heard it from the siddha Karṇaśrī. The text breaks off at Tarpa Lotsāwa's name, suggesting the colophon continues beyond the passage provided.

The phrase rendered "intoxicated and overwhelmed a hundredfold" translates a somewhat compressed construction; the sense is that the assembly was overcome with wonder and reverence to an extraordinary degree.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.